

SSC Phase 4: Setup Checklist

A print-it-out, tick-it-off checklist for actually doing the conversion - no explanations, just the steps in order. If you'd like to understand **why** first, read the [Simple Guide](#). If a step here doesn't say enough and you want the full detail, the same step is covered in the [Technical Guide](#).

WARNING: Electrical safety - please read first

Every step in this checklist is software and cabling - **nothing here involves opening a wall box or touching mains wiring**. If you ever find yourself about to do that, stop: that's a licensed electrician's job, not part of this checklist.

IMPORTANT: Disclaimer

This checklist is shared by a neighbour, for neighbours, as a community learning resource - it is **not** professional advice and comes with **no warranty**. This is a personal DIY project inside your own villa; community management is not involved. Help comes from neighbours in the WhatsApp group. Proceed at your own pace and risk - see the full disclaimer in the [Technical Guide](#).

Every checkbox is small on purpose. If one ever takes more than about 15 minutes or you're not sure what you're looking at, that's your cue to post a photo/question in the WhatsApp group rather than guessing.

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My setup info

Fill this in as you go - you'll need these values again and again over the next steps.

What	Value
My Raspberry Pi's address	http://homeassistant.local:8123 (usually works as-is)
My SLZB-06M's IP address	
My MQTT username (you choose this in Stage 3)	

What	Value
My TIS VRF AC controller's IP address	
My Tailscale account email (Stage 7)	

Stage 1: Buy the parts

- ☐ Raspberry Pi 5, **8 GB RAM** version
- ☐ Official Raspberry Pi 5 USB-C power supply (27 W)
- ☐ microSD card, **64 GB or larger**, A2-rated
- ☐ SMLIGHT **SLZB-06M** (Zigbee coordinator)
- ☐ 1-2 Ethernet cables

That's everything - your existing switches, motion sensors, and air-conditioning are reused, not bought again.

Stage 2: Set up the Raspberry Pi

- ☐ On a laptop/PC, download [Raspberry Pi Imager](#)
- ☐ Open it, choose device **Raspberry Pi 5**
- ☐ Choose OS → **Home Assistant** → **Home Assistant OS**
- ☐ Choose storage → your microSD card
- ☐ Click **Write**, and wait for it to finish (don't unplug the card early)
- ☐ Put the microSD card into the Pi
- ☐ Connect the Pi to your router with an Ethernet cable
- ☐ Connect the power supply to boot it
- ☐ Wait about 10 minutes for first boot (grab a coffee)
- ☐ On a phone/laptop on the same Wi-Fi, open a browser to `http://homeassistant.local:8123`
- ☐ Follow the on-screen wizard: create your name, username, and a **strong password** - write the password down somewhere safe
- ☐ When asked about location/currency/unit system, fill in your own
- ☐ Skip adding devices for now - click through to the dashboard
- ☐ Go to **Settings** → **System** → **Updates** and install anything pending, then wait for the Pi to restart

SOS Stuck? If `homeassistant.local` doesn't load, find the Pi's IP address from your router's device list instead and use `http://<that-ip>:8123`.

Stage 3: Install the add-ons

- ☐ Go to **Settings** → **Add-ons** → **Add-on Store**
- ☐ Search for **Mosquitto broker**, install it, then start it
- ☐ Under the Mosquitto add-on's **Configuration** tab, add a login for Zigbee2MQTT to use (pick any username/password that isn't your HA admin login) - write them into the worksheet above

- ☐ Back in the Add-on Store, search for **Zigbee2MQTT**, and install it (don't start it yet)

Stage 4: Connect the Zigbee coordinator

- ☐ Plug the SLZB-06M into your router with an Ethernet cable, and power it on
- ☐ Find its IP address (check your router's connected-devices list, or the SMLIGHT app/instructions that came with it) - write it into the worksheet above
- ☐ Open the Zigbee2MQTT add-on's **Configuration** tab and paste this in, changing only the IP address and the MQTT username/password from Stage 3:

```
serial:
  port: tcp://192.0.2.50:6638 # <-- your SLZB-06M's IP from the worksheet
  adapter: ezsp

mqtt:
  base_topic: zigbee2mqtt
  server: mqtt://core-mosquitto:1883
  user: <your Mosquitto username>
  password: <your Mosquitto password>
```

yaml

- ☐ Save, then **start** the Zigbee2MQTT add-on
- ☐ Open the Zigbee2MQTT panel (left sidebar) and check it shows the coordinator as connected, not an error

SOS Stuck? Double-check the IP address is exactly right and that the Pi and the SLZB-06M are both plugged into the same router - this is the single most common snag, and a neighbour who's done it can usually spot it fast.

- ☐ Go to **Settings → Devices & Services → Add Integration**, search for **MQTT**, and point it at the same broker (core-mosquitto)

Stage 5: Move your switches and sensors over

This is one room at a time - there's no rush, and nothing breaks if you stop partway and come back later.

For **each** light switch or motion sensor you want to move:

- ☐ Open the Zigbee2MQTT panel and turn on **Permit join**
- ☐ Put that specific device into pairing mode (button-press or power-cycle sequence - **ask in the WhatsApp group for your exact device model**, since it varies and neighbours who've done it already know the sequence)
- ☐ Watch the Zigbee2MQTT log until the device appears as joined
- ☐ Rename it to something clear, e.g. `living_room_ceiling_light` or `hallway_motion`
- ☐ Test it from the Zigbee2MQTT panel or a dashboard tile before moving to the next device

SOS This is the step most worth doing alongside a neighbour the first time - once you've seen one device paired, the rest are the same pattern.

Stage 6: Get your air-conditioning working

This step edits a configuration file by hand - if that sounds daunting, this is a good one to ask a technical neighbour to do with you.

- ☐ Find your TIS VRF AC controller's IP address (check your router's device list)

☐ Install the **File editor** add-on from the Add-on Store (or ask a neighbour to help you connect via Samba/SSH instead)

☐ Open `configuration.yaml` and add, changing only the IP (and username/ password if your installer set any):

```
climate:
  - platform: ac_vrf
    host: 192.0.2.251    # <-- your AC controller's IP
```

yaml

☐ Follow the [hass-tis-vrf-ac](#) repository's own install instructions to add the integration files themselves (via HACS or by copying the files in) - this only needs doing once, before the config above will work

☐ Restart Home Assistant (**Settings → System → Restart**)

☐ Check a new air-conditioning entity appears, and test turning it on/off

Stage 7 (optional): Control it from your phone, away from home

Skip this stage entirely if you're happy only controlling things while on your home Wi-Fi - everything above already works fully without it.

☐ Go to **Settings → Add-ons → Add-on Store**, install the **Tailscale** add-on, and start it

☐ Open the add-on's web UI and sign in (Google/Microsoft/GitHub login all work) - write the account email into the worksheet

☐ Install the **Tailscale** app on your phone from your app store, and sign in with the **same** account

☐ Install the **Home Assistant** companion app on your phone, and connect it using the Tailscale address shown in the add-on's log

Stage 8: Protect your work

☐ Go to **Settings → System → Backups** and create a backup

☐ Turn on automatic backups if offered

☐ Note somewhere outside the Pi (phone notes, cloud drive) where that backup is stored

You're done - what next

☐ Browse the [automation library](#) for ideas other villas are using, and try adding one

☐ Share anything you learned (a pairing sequence, a snag and its fix) back to the WhatsApp group or this repository so the next neighbour has an easier time